```
order.pay_type = "Purchase order"
order.save
```

This code uses the new `Order` class to fetch the order with an `id` of `1` and modify the `pay_type`. (For now, we've omitted the code that creates a database connection.) Active Record relieves us of the hassles of dealing with the underlying database, leaving us free to work on business logic.

But Active Record does more than that. As you'll see when we develop our shopping cart application, starting in Chapter 5, *The Depot Application*, Active Record integrates seamlessly with the rest of the Rails framework. If a web form sends the application data related to a business object, Active Record can extract it into our model. Active Record supports sophisticated validation of model data, and if the form data fails validations, the Rails views can extract and format errors.

Active Record is the solid model foundation of the Rails MVC architecture.